



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Lexington Latin School

School Website: <https://www.lexingtonlatinschool.com/>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

SCL MEMBER

Any school that belongs to the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because SCL requires adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL

Executive Summary

Lexington Latin School (LLS) presents a robust classical Christian program centered on formation, virtue, and the classical liberal arts. Public materials consistently frame education as formation in truth, goodness, and beauty, rooted in a Christian worldview and the Great Tradition. The school foregrounds Latin, Great Books/Great Conversation through a curriculum that emphasizes the trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric), Sacred Scripture, and a life of virtue. Public materials also highlight a strong parental partnership, a House-based upper-school culture, and a disciplined traditional classroom ethos.

Overall, the school earns a CLASSICAL rating across most criteria, with Element 4 (Pedagogy) showing only partial alignment where explicit Socratic/seminar-based practices are not as plainly documented as other elements. The aggregate assessment is CLASSICAL.

- Religious and Metaphysical Foundations: CLASSICAL. Evidence emphasizes a Christian, Gospel-guided education, liturgical/worship implications, and the goal of forming Christian character and wisdom.
- Purpose and Goal: CLASSICAL. Emphasis on formation, virtue, and wisdom; education as a human formation aimed at truth/beauty rather than job training.
- Curriculum: CLASSICAL. Explicit focus on Latin, grammar/logic/rhetoric, Great Books/Great Conversation, and a liberal-arts orientation.
- Pedagogy: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL. Recitation/memory and contemplative/restful elements are documented for lower grades; upper grades show rhetoric and classical study, but explicit Socratic/seminar-based pedagogy is not consistently evidenced across the high school years.
- Faculty: CLASSICAL. Public materials describe a traditional, teacher-led model with mentors and a "portrait" of teachers and a culture of virtue; named administrators and faculty indicate a strong living-lesson approach.
- Parents & Community: CLASSICAL. Strong emphasis on partnership with parents, parental formation resources, and open access to visits/gatherings.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

- Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL
- Evidence: Christian identity and Gospel-guided formation; liturgical/community cues (sacred music, worship); theology-integrated formation claims; education as formation in truth, goodness, and beauty.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive indicators (truth, goodness, beauty, virtue, theology, liturgy, reverence, wonder, Logos, imago Dei, wisdom); Negative indicators: none detected in materials. 12+ positive keywords vs 0 negative signals.

- Why this rating: Material shows a coherent Christian metaphysical grounding and explicit reference to virtue/theology; alignment with classical categories of formation and liturgical life.
- Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL
- Evidence: Formation-focused aims; emphasis on virtue, wisdom, and human flourishing; “Great Tradition” and “Truth, Goodness, & Beauty” as teloi; formation over merely informational aims.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive indicators include formation, virtue, wisdom, liberal education, telos, great conversation; Negative signals (e.g., workforce-prep emphasis) are notably absent in public materials; counts skew heavily positive. 8–12 positives vs 0 negatives.
- Why this rating: The public materials consistently present formation and virtue as the ultimate goals of education, consistent with classical paideia.
- Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL
- Evidence: Explicit focus on Latin as core; grammar/logic/rhetoric in curriculum; study of Greek/Latin classics; Shakespeare; the Great Books/Great Conversation framing; historical breadth; emphasis on the liberal arts.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords include Seven Liberal Arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric), Latin, Great Books, Shakespeare, history/Western civilization, unity of truth across disciplines, wonder; negative signals (per the Lexicon) not evident in the public materials. 8–12 positives vs 0 negatives.
- Why this rating: Curriculum explicitly embraces the classical triad and liberal-arts structure, with direct references to Great Books and Latin-centered pedagogy.
- Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Evidence: Lower-school focus on recitation, memory, singing, and contemplative pedagogy; upper-school attention to logic and rhetoric; explicit rhetoric instruction and senior-level writing; House-system and traditions; some indication of Socratic-like discussion in HS via course structures, but not as explicit as the core pedagogy indicators.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords present include scholé, memorization/recitation, chanting, liturgical integration, rhetoric, seminar/debate (in some courses), and memory-work; negative signals (like exclusive project-based learning or purely experiential approaches) are not emphasized; overall, several classical-pedagogy indicators exist, but explicit high-school Socratic/seminar-dialectic evidence is less consistently documented. 6–10 positives vs 1–2 weaker indicators.
- Why this rating: The school uses a mix of memory-based, contemplative pedagogy for early grades and rhetoric/logic-focused teaching for upper grades, which fits classical aims but lacks consistently explicit Socratic/seminar-based practice across all grades. Therefore SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.
- Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL
- Evidence: Public materials profile a Head of School, Upper School Dean, Lower School Principal, and named faculty, plus language about teachers as mentors and the living curriculum; emphasis on character formation and virtuous teaching.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords include mentors, living curriculum, portrait of the teacher, character formation, virtuous exemplars, collegial culture; negative keywords in the Lexicon are not evidenced in materials. 6–10 positives vs 0–1 negatives.
- Why this rating: The materials present a strong teacher-formation ethos and a clearly defined faculty/core-team structure aligned with classical expectations.
- Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

- Evidence: Repeated emphasis on partnering with parents, parental formation resources, open-campus access, and parent involvement; explicit statements about education “in partnership with parents” and “co-teachers” with the school.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords include partnership with parents, parent formation, classical book clubs, open campus, family liturgy alignment; negative signals are not present. 6–12 positives vs 0 negatives.
- Why this rating: The school frames parents as co-teachers and actively engages families through resources and events, consistent with classical-community models.

Aggregate Assessment - The school earns CLASSICAL overall, with Element 4 representing the only partial alignment (SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL). The remaining categories align strongly with classical criteria (Religious Foundations, Purpose/Goal, Curriculum, Faculty, and Parents/Community). The aggregate is CLASSICAL.

What Would Move the Needle - Element 4 (Pedagogy) could move from SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL to CLASSICAL with targeted enhancements: - Implement explicit, documented Socratic/seminar-based pedagogy at the upper-school level, with publicly available exemplars of Socratic discussions and sample Great-Books seminar prompts. - Expand publicly accessible descriptions of scholé days, contemplative pauses, and memory-work integration across all grades, with concrete examples beyond lower-school recitation. - Publish a formal “Pedagogy Playbook” showing how Great Books, Trivium-based content, and rhetoric are integrated in classroom practice, including teacher training materials. - Provide explicit, public articulation of a systematic, high-school-level Socratic program (e.g., Paideia-style seminars) and how it connects with the Great Conversation in texts like Shakespeare, Greek tragedy, and canonical works.

- No other category requires major needle-moving changes given the strong alignment across religious/metaphysical foundations, purpose/goal, curriculum, faculty, and parent/community.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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